



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 7

CONNECTICUT

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Connecticut's family courts and child-welfare system.

32

CONNECTICUT FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
64 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 30
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 14, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

15 OF 8

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

CONNECTICUT AT A GLANCE.

Across 32 Connecticut families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 64 30 of 32 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$209,000 median across 14 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 30 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 53.1% 50.0% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 32	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 2.1	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 30 of 32	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 15

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Connecticut families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF CONNECTICUT FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	19	\$20,000	\$182,016	\$3,458,301
Lost Wages	18	\$20,000	\$120,233	\$2,164,200
Other Court Fees	12	\$5,000	\$9,583	\$115,000
Therapy / Evaluations	12	\$5,000	\$10,983	\$131,800
Reunification Services	9	\$0	\$3,944	\$35,500
GAL Fees	12	\$4,000	\$13,917	\$167,000
Asset Loss	12	\$72,500	\$258,333	\$3,100,000
Median Family Burden (14 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$209,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		30	2.5 yrs
Mean months lost		36	3 yrs
Total across all families		649	54.1 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · CONNECTICUT

Most families documenting in Connecticut are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		21	66%
Not provided		5	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		2	6%
Case closed: within last 2 years		1	3%
Active case: progress being made		1	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		17	53%
Both Family Court and CPS		7	22%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		3	9%
Unknown		3	9%
Family Court		1	3%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

5 – 10 years		11	34%
Over 10 years		6	19%
1 – 3 years		5	16%
3 – 5 years		3	9%
6 months – 1 year		2	6%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		12	38%
50/50 Joint		6	19%
Visitation Only		6	19%
Full Custody		4	12%
Children in Foster Care		3	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Fairfield		5	16%
New Haven		4	12%
New London		2	6%
Middlesex		2	6%
Waterbury Court		1	3%
Putnam		1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		9	28%
High Conflict Divorce		8	25%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		7	22%
Family Court		3	9%
Other		2	6%

04 PARENT VOICES — CONNECTICUT

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Connecticut comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



I'm destroyed. My children are selfharming and/or think the world is better without them.

— JESSICA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Iverson was wrongly taken by his father, who has schizoaffective bipolar disorder and demonstrated ongoing delusions, yet despite six months of filings in two courts with documented proof, my concerns were repeatedly ignored. Instead of hearing or reviewing the evidence, the [...]

— CONNECTICUT PARENT · SAMANTHA VALDEZ

MORE VOICES FROM CONNECTICUT

Gave abuse my children after I was the original plaintiff requested relwif from abuse

— LEI

Destroyed everything I and my kids believed in. We trust no one now.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Caused severe disabilities to me & children otherwise would be absent, halted my education in my masters degree & work as a nurse and both of my children's developmental health. Took away our autonomy , piled on further violence and traumatized any trust in systems that [...]

— MELISSA

Traumatized what should have been a perfectly normal childhood and motherhood by giving voice to the abuser to profit an entire system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Family Court has systematically and constructively alienated me from my children's lives. I contend that the court has prioritized financial profiteering for court-appointed actors and the custodial parent over the best interests of the children and my fundamental parental [...]

— SHANE J.

They have separated us with no end in near sight. They stop my children due to a scorned woman who used lies and deceit to her favor.

— STEVEN

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They have taken my daughter childhood and my happiness and life from me only because I fought against abuse, this demonic system must end. Now!!!

— NATASHA

Case was opened because of my husband's abusive disciplinary actions. This led to older son becoming aggressive toward his sister. Yet he 13 and sister is 10. My children were removed because they said I put my children in harms way. My youngest daughter was given to the same [...]

— DANIELLA

They have destroyed everything. I have lost my place of residence. My means of transportation due to a narcissistic ex-wife I pay substantial amount of child support which is \$360 a week. In the past 5 years I have maybe seen my children a dozen times. I have not seen them in 2 [...]

— DERRICK

My family has been robbed, deprived, and destroyed by DCF.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Fucking destroyed us

— CATHERINE

It has suppressed a mom trying to implement faith and morals and sided with actions of corruption and views of other because it was more mainstream. Faith and conservative morals was not favored but rather bias favoritism.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I never imagined I would be in this position—fighting just to maintain a relationship with my own child. I am a mother who has followed the law, held custody under a valid court order, and done everything I can to provide stability, education, and care. Yet despite that, I have [...]

— BRISEIDA

The system is complicit in domestic violence..they literally participate in post separation abuse by claiming intelligent ignorance about domestic violence and refuse to hear evidence labeling these as high conflict and allowing the litigious abuse to continue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This prolonged family court battle has devastated our lives—driving me into over \$100,000 of legal debt, severely damaging my mental health and private practice, and forcing me to live in constant fear that despite extensive evidence, the system may still place my son alone with [...]

— EMMA

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Financially devastated and bankrupt me and our three kids. Financially, emotionally, and psychologically. While he has amassed millions in properties and cars Etc. This was about torturing me and making me pay using our three kids. I've said going to court has been his drug of [...]

— LISA

I became chronically ill and could not work for almost a decade after the case was closed my ex went on a rampage and completed the final blow of getting my son to hate us. The eyes of the court were off of him and he succeeded. On a visitation my then 15 year old sexually [...]

— JENNIFER

19 Connecticut parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 19 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — CONNECTICUT

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Connecticut families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

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— JESSICA

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— DERRICK

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I never imagined I would be in this position—fighting just to maintain a relationship with my own child. I am a mother who has followed the law, held custody under a valid court order, and done everything I can to provide stability, education, and care. Yet despite that, I have faced a situation where my child was not returned after visitation, and my ability to communicate and stay connected has been limited. This experience has shown me how difficult and overwhelming the system can be for parents trying to do the right thing. When processes are incomplete or one-sided, it can impact not just a parent—but a child's sense of stability, security, and emotional well-being. I am not sharing this to create conflict, but to bring awareness. Children deserve consistency. They deserve both parents when it is safe and appropriate. And parents deserve a fair and complete process. I will continue to advocate for my child—with strength, with dignity, and with the hope that the system ultimately protects what matters most: the best interests of the child.

— BRISEIDA

Iverson was wrongly taken by his father, who has schizoaffective bipolar disorder and demonstrated ongoing delusions, yet despite six months of filings in two courts with documented proof, my concerns were repeatedly ignored. Instead of hearing or reviewing the evidence, the court escalated matters by placing my son into CPS care without fully considering the facts I presented.

— SAMANTHA VALDEZ

The system is complicit in domestic violence..they literally participate in post separation abuse by claiming intelligent ignorance about domestic violence and refuse to hear evidence labeling these as high conflict and allowing the litigious abuse to continue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This prolonged family court battle has devastated our lives—driving me into over \$100,000 of legal debt, severely damaging my mental health and private practice, and forcing me to live in constant fear that despite extensive evidence, the system may still place my son alone with a parent who has already endangered his physical and emotional safety. It has robbed my son of the carefree childhood he once had and robbed me of the ability to be fully present as his mother, as we both now live under the weight of anxiety, manipulation, and the ongoing threat that the system meant to protect him could fail him.

— EMMA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Financially devastated and bankrupt me and our three kids. Financially, emotionally, and psychologically. While he has amassed millions in properties and cars Etc. This was about torturing me and making me pay using our three kids. I've said going to court has been his drug of choice. With no end in sight but I refuse to go back to Family Court. I will never stop. People like all of us, and my Rock the Walls this year will be different and we will be so loud they can't ignore any of us anymore. I'M DONE!!!

— LISA

I became chronically ill and could not work for almost a decade after the case was closed my ex went on a rampage and completed the final blow of getting my son to hate us. The eyes of the court were off of him and he succeeded. On a visitation my then 15 year old sexually assaulted his half brother my son who had just turned 5 at the time. During the assault he told his little brother he hates him he hates me and is also going to assault me as well, he told my then 5 year old he would kill him if he told anyone. The police are involved and when interviewed by police my ex told them I made it all up to get them back for winning sole custody. We are waiting for my son to heal enough to complete the forensic interview as he was so young nervous and could not articulate to the interviewer. After police contacted my ex and son they cut contact with me and I have not seen or spoken to him since August 17 2023. We still have a parenting time with orders for communication but I have been so traumatized by this experience and am in therapy to build the endurance for when my now 7 year old talks to police and the DA gets involved.

— JENNIFER

19 full approved Connecticut comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT**WHAT THIS IS**

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Connecticut report comes from Connecticut respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Connecticut — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 32 Connecticut families reporting here are not the universe of Connecticut families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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